IMESI

International Mutual Economic Security Instrument

Ministerial Digest

Version 10.0

March 2026

Four-Page Summary for Ministers and Senior Officials

REFERENCE ARCHITECTURE — FOR OPEN CIRCULATION

WHAT IMESI IS

IMESI is a mutual economic security insurance mechanism. It protects member states against economic coercion—the use of trade, investment, or financial measures to compel sovereign policy changes—by pooling intelligence, stabilisation resources, and coordinated response capacity. It operates as a modular framework, enabling Members to calibrate participation across tiers, sectors, and response tools consistent with their domestic law, capacity, and political preferences.

Four Core Functions

- Insurance. Collective burden-sharing against economic blackmail, with a hard annual exposure cap of 0.25% of GDP per member.
- Intelligence. Early warning of coercive threats 30–90 days before public escalation, including AI-driven regulatory pattern tracking.
- Infrastructure. Alternative supply chains, payment systems (including CBDC-ready settlement), and strategic reserves.
- Stabilisation. Credible collective response making coercion strategically irrational.

What IMESI Is Not

IMESI is not a trade bloc, a geopolitical alliance, or a defence pact. Even where coercion coincides with armed-force threats, IMESI remains strictly an economic stabilisation mechanism—nothing may be interpreted as a mutual defence pact or authorisation for the use of force. It does not set tariffs, require foreign-policy coordination beyond resisting coercion, or delegate trade sovereignty. It applies equally to all states—including its own members—with no predetermined targets. A Regulatory Sovereignty Firewall ensures IMESI cannot prescribe or harmonise domestic regulation.

HOW IMESI WORKS: THREE CLOCKS

Ministers need remember only three layers. All detailed timelines are calibrations of these:

- Hours: Automatic stabilisation. Track A measures—liquidity, swap lines, supply-chain rerouting—deploy within hours. No vote required. This is the insurance payout.
- Days: Political decisions. The CC votes on Phase 1 trade measures (55% threshold). The Rapid Legitimacy Signal Panel publishes a 72-hour advisory assessment. Quiet consultation gives the coercer a face-saving off-ramp.
- Months: Accountability. Deep reviews at 90 days force active decisions. Phase 2+ measures expire at 120 days without renewal. Cases close or continue at 180 days. No open-ended commitments.

Scenario: Targeted Coercion Against a Member

- Day 0 — Trigger. A member reports discriminatory restrictions linked to a political demand. Documentation submitted to the IEWC.
- Days 0–3 — Phase 0 automatic stabilisation. Resilience Fund liquidity released; supply-chain rerouting activated; swap-line coordination initiated. Pre-authorised—no vote required.
- Days 3–5 — Legitimacy signal + quiet consultation. RLSM Panel publishes advisory Legitimacy Note. Confidential backchannel with coercing state offers resolution before public escalation.
- Days 5–7 — Phase 1 activation. CC votes (55%). Trade, procurement, and regulatory countermeasures at 15–30% intensity. Financial instruments excluded. Members choose full, selective, silent, or MVIL participation. Standard Response Templates available for recurring patterns.
- Day 30+ — Escalation or resolution. Phased escalation with mandatory reviews (30/90/180-day cycle) and 120-day automatic sunset. Off-ramps and mediation at every stage. Managed Adjustment Option available for members under domestic strain.

Parallel frameworks exist for systemic disruption (stabilisation-first; routine MFN-consistent policy explicitly excluded from triggers), small-state cluster coercion (automatic aggregation + non-abandonment), and attribution-uncertain grey-zone cases (reversible Phase 0 only, 30-day auto-expiry). Full detail: IMESI v10.0, pages 8–18.

GOVERNANCE AND CONTROL

Who Controls It

- Coordination Committee (CC): All member states, weighted by GDP/trade. Authorises all Phase 1+ measures. No single member can veto any decision once thresholds are met.
- IEWC: 5 core + 3 affected-member + 2 independent seats. Certifies coercion with published methodology; dissent published; borderline cases auto-referred to external review. Small-state members receive dedicated analyst support and 10-day immersion programme.
- RLSM Panel: 3 independent experts issue 72-hour public Legitimacy Note (consistent/borderline/inconsistent). Advisory only—no delay to measures.
- IAC: Independent jurists. Appeals and consistency review. Confirms Systemic Forbearance findings.
- Secretariat: Implements CC decisions. Cannot initiate countermeasures. Annual external audit. Director-General appointment requires 70% + small-state support.
- National IMESI Authority: Each member designates a single cross-agency contact point.

How Members Maintain Sovereignty

• Democratic Override: Any parliament can reject any measure. • Selective/Silent Participation: Case-by-case, measure-level choice. • MVIL: Light-touch participation mode for cautious or low-capacity governments. • Non-Coordination Safe Harbour: Use your own tools; no identical tariffs required. • Implementation Flexibility Menu: Choose from 5 channels (trade, procurement, financial-lite, regulatory, pure stabilisation). • Automatic Sunset: All Phase 2+ expires at 120 days. • Grand Review: Full treaty review every 6 years. • Mandatory 5-year performance audit by non-member panel.

No Country Can Weaponise This

No single country can trigger, block, or control certifications. No state sits on the IEWC while accused. Certification requires 7-of-10 IEWC majority including 2 independent experts. Quorum resilience ensures vacancies cannot paralyse operations. Budget continuity prevents funding hostage-taking. Multi-host distribution ensures no single country controls institutional infrastructure.

BUILT-IN SAFEGUARDS

- Mis-Activation → Non-Use Guarantee + independent validation + Misuse Liability + False Positive Compensation if wrong.
- Escalation → Cascade Circuit-Breaker + Tariff Ceiling + No First Use of financial weapons + 120-day sunset + Symmetric Restraint for systemic economies (enhanced 7-day consultation + Proportionality Note before vote).
- Legal Conflict → WTO Defence-in-Depth Protocol with model legal reasoning; Compatibility Assurance; mandatory assessment before Phase 2+.
- Defection → Solidarity-First principle (cooperative options first); Managed Adjustment for domestic strain; Contained Non-Participation rebalances burden without collapse; anonymised compliance reporting.
- Corruption → Off-book inducements to fracture coalition = Tier 1 violation; confidential remediation pathway; 75% CC vote for aggravated misconduct.
- Cognitive Coercion → Strict scope: applies only to operations linked to economic coercion. Does not apply to political discourse, media, or civil society advocacy.

FINANCIAL SNAPSHOT

Contributions: Large economy ~0.06–0.08% GDP/year. Mid-size ~0.03–0.05%. Small/LDC ~0.01–0.02%. Hard annual cap: 0.25% GDP. For a 12-member coalition (~USD 45T GDP): ~USD 2.2–4.5B/year, 5-year fund target ~USD 11–22B. Typical medium case: ~0.02–0.05% of combined GDP over 12 months. No single activation may draw >15% of Fund without 75% vote. Designed for 2 simultaneous medium cases + 1 small case within caps. 10% Contingent Continuity Band ensures core operations survive any single member’s contribution shortfall.

MEMBERSHIP TIERS

Observer+ — Intelligence sharing; no obligations.
Associate — Select 3+ cooperation domains; limited obligations.
Full — Comprehensive commitments; maximum protection.
Enhanced Solidarity — Highest coordination for major economies.

MVIL mode available at any tier for light-touch participation. Founding Observer Track: 12–24 month zero-obligation trial.

Peacetime benefits from Month 1: joint procurement (10–18% savings), early-warning intelligence, SFI settlement access, Resilience Fund eligibility, supply-chain rerouting, Economic Entanglement Index exposure alerts, and Coercion Risk Dashboard signalling credible collective backing.

FOUNDING COALITION STRATEGY

- LAUNCH (Year 1): EU core, UK, Canada, Japan, Australia, South Korea—10–12 founding states. Minimum Viable Coalition: 6 members at 15% global GDP.
- PROVE (Years 2–3): 1–2 successful cases. Pre-Activated Core provides day-one value: intelligence sharing, procurement pilots, risk dashboards.
- EXPAND (Years 4–5): Broader accession. Open Architecture allows non-members to join selected modules without full membership.
- TARGET (Year 5+): 30–40 members at 45%+ of global GDP.

Three Pathways

- Path A — G7/G20 Task Force (18–24 months to drafting conference).
- Path B — OECD/WTO Joint Initiative (24–36 months; higher multilateral legitimacy).
- Path C — Regional Pilot (12–18 months; fastest to operational proof of concept).

Who Moves First

IMESI can move from concept to pilot if three willing major economies and two small states jointly task their sherpas—at a G7, OECD, or regional summit—to launch a 12–18 month pilot under simplified scope. Five governments, one MoU, one working group.

POLITICAL SUSTAINABILITY

- Manageable initial fund, scaling with membership. First-Mover Protection for founding members.
- Five-year mandatory review + independent performance audit. 70% supermajority to expand scope.
- Sectoral modularity + MVIL + Selective Participation. Founding Phase limits scope to tariffs + basic liquidity.
- Peacetime benefits begin immediately. Private-sector engagement through Business Council and Corporate Execution Protocol.
- Biennial Leaders’ Meeting for political guidance. Transparency Ledger for coalition awareness. Legitimacy Dashboard for public accountability.
- Withdrawal does not affect prior decisions or remaining members’ authority.

NEXT STEPS FOR MINISTERS

1. Review this digest and identify questions for a technical briefing on the full IMESI v10.0 framework (230 pages, available for open circulation).
2. Designate a senior official to participate in informal scoping consultations at the next available ministerial margins (G7, OECD, or WTO Ministerial).
3. Consider whether your government would participate in a low-risk tabletop pilot exercise (Path C) requiring no binding commitments.

This digest summarises IMESI v10.0 (March 2026). The full framework text is available for open circulation and detailed review.